Policy ID: POL-001
Title: Conflict of Interest Policy
Version: 1.0 | Effective date: 1 January 2026 | Owner: Ethics Office

SYNTHETIC DOCUMENT - fictional guidance created for a technical prototype. It does not describe any real organisation's policy.

Conflict of Interest Policy

1. Purpose

This policy explains what a conflict of interest is, when employees must disclose one, and how to report a possible conflict of interest involving another person.

2. What is a conflict of interest

A conflict of interest exists when a personal, financial or family interest could interfere, or appear to interfere, with an employee's duty to act in the best interests of the Organisation.

Examples include: taking part in a procurement decision that involves a supplier owned by a relative; holding outside employment or a directorship with a supplier, customer or competitor; holding a significant financial stake in a company the employee manages a contract with; and hiring or supervising a close family member or partner.

3. Duty to disclose your own conflict

Employees must disclose a potential conflict of interest before taking part in any related decision, and in any case within 10 business days of becoming aware of it.

Disclosures are made through the Conflict of Interest Declaration form on the Integrity Portal. Until the Ethics Office responds, the employee must step back from the related decision.

4. Reporting a possible conflict of interest involving someone else

If you become aware of a possible conflict of interest involving a colleague, manager or supplier, raise it as a concern under POL-003 Raising a Concern.

Your report should describe the possible conflict and give the approximate date or period when it occurred or when you became aware of it. You do not need proof, and you should not investigate the matter yourself.

5. What happens after a disclosure or report

The Ethics Office reviews each disclosure or report. Possible outcomes include no action, a written mitigation plan (for example, removing the employee from a decision), or referral for investigation. Records are kept confidential in line with POL-005.

6. Related policies

POL-003 Raising a Concern; POL-004 Gifts and Hospitality Policy; POL-005 Non-Retaliation and Confidentiality Policy.